

USER INTERFACE AND DESIGN

Experiment – 3(a)

Create a prototype with familiar and unfamiliar navigation elements. Evaluate ease of use with different user groups using proto.io

Familiar Navigation

AIM:

The aim is to build a prototype using familiar navigation patterns and test how easy it is for different types of users to use it.

PROCEDURE:

1. Sign up on proto.io and start a new mobile project.
2. Design screens using common UI elements like search bars, bottom tab bars, and labeled buttons.
3. Link the screens using tap/click actions.
4. Share the prototype with users and collect feedback.
5. Note where users had trouble or moved through easily.

OVERVIEW OF FAMILIAR NAVIGATION:

Familiar navigation uses patterns that people already know from everyday apps — like tapping buttons, using a search bar, or a bottom menu. Since users already understand these patterns, they can use the app quickly without needing any instructions. The prototype here is a shopping app that uses these familiar patterns throughout.

Group 1: Home Screen and Category Navigation

The home screen has a search bar at the top and two big buttons — "View Sales" and "View Cart". There is also a bottom navigation bar with icons. This layout is similar to most shopping apps, so users felt comfortable right away. The categories screen shows four icons in a grid — Male, Female, Electronics, and Plants.

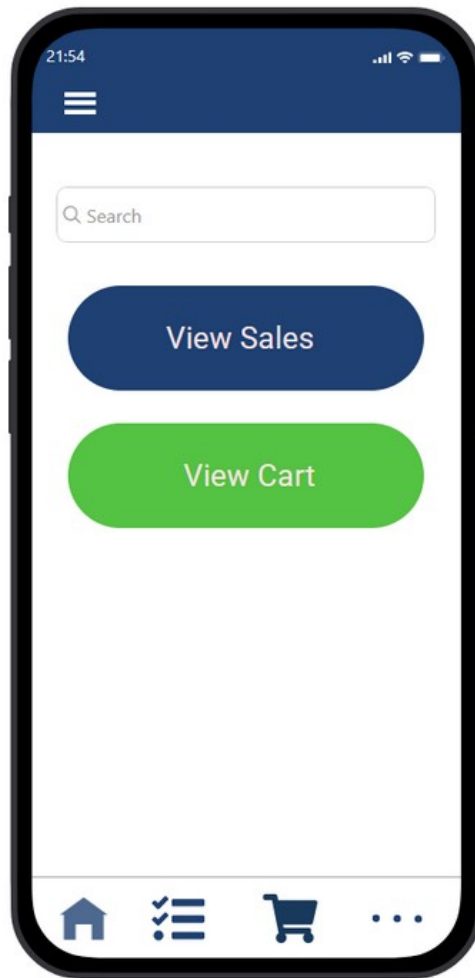


Fig 1: Home Screen

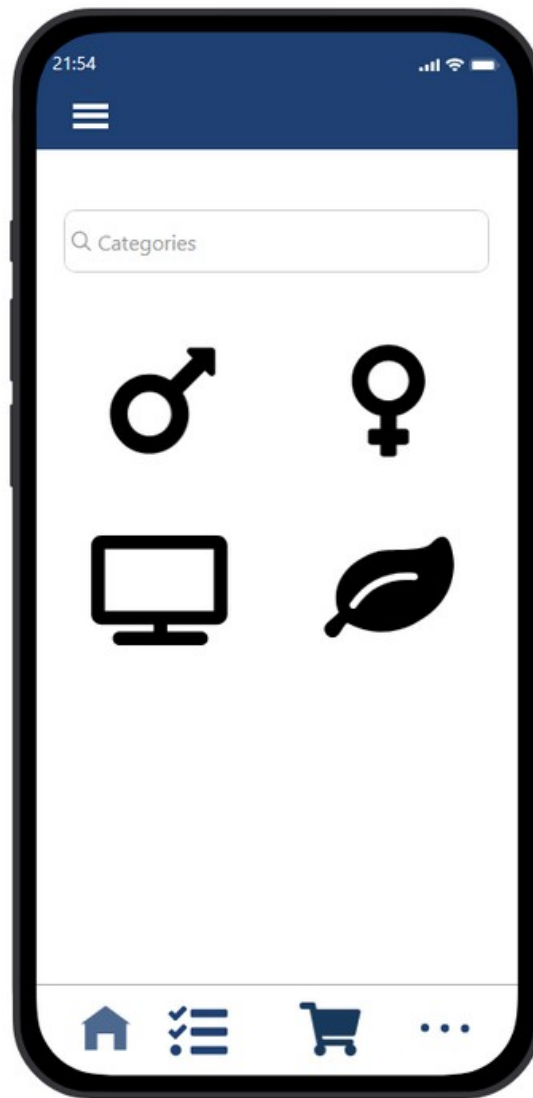


Fig 2: Category Screen

Group 2: Product Detail Screens

Each product page shows a large image, availability status, product name, and description. A blue "+" button lets users add items to the cart. All product screens look the same, so users quickly get used to the layout. The products shown are a Men's Coat, Black Sandals, a PC Bundle, and an Indoor Plant.

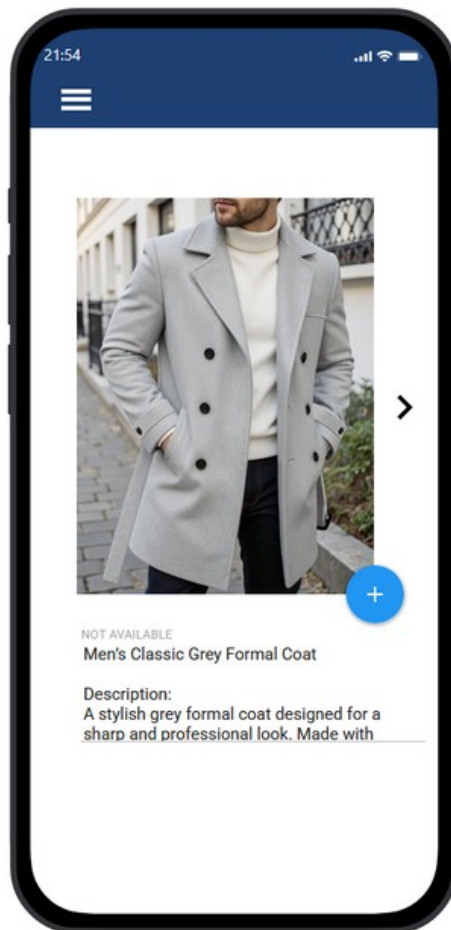


Fig 3: Men's Coat

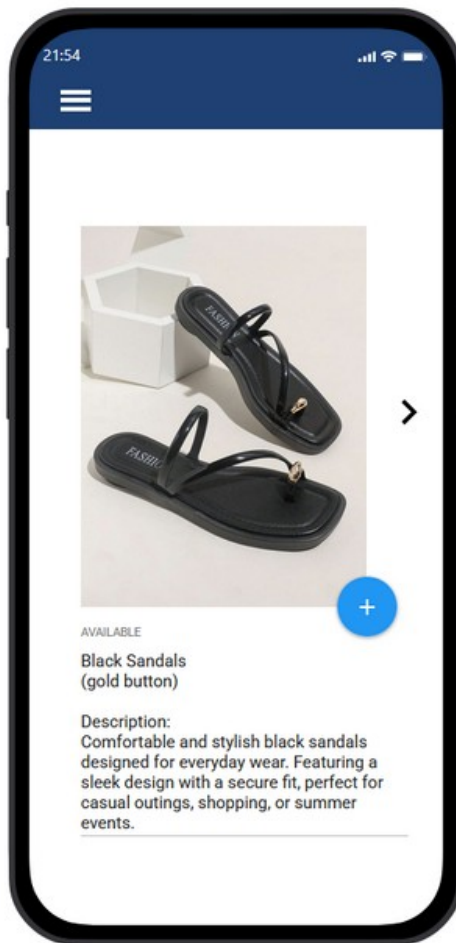


Fig 4: Black Sandals

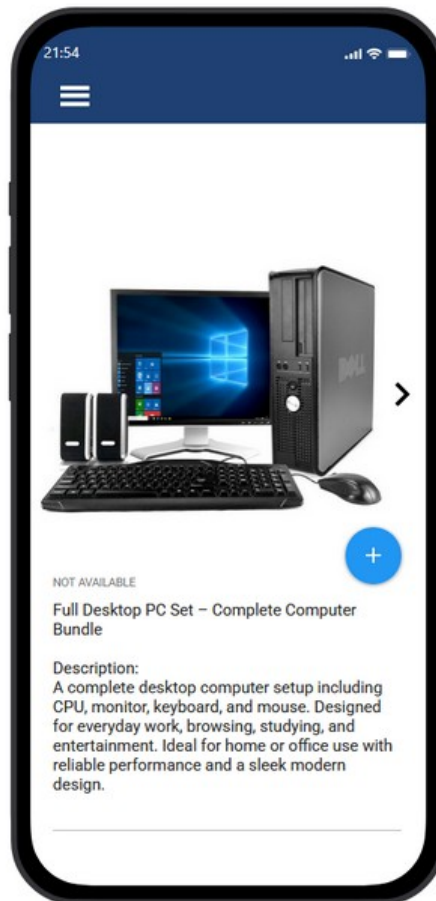


Fig 5: PC Bundle

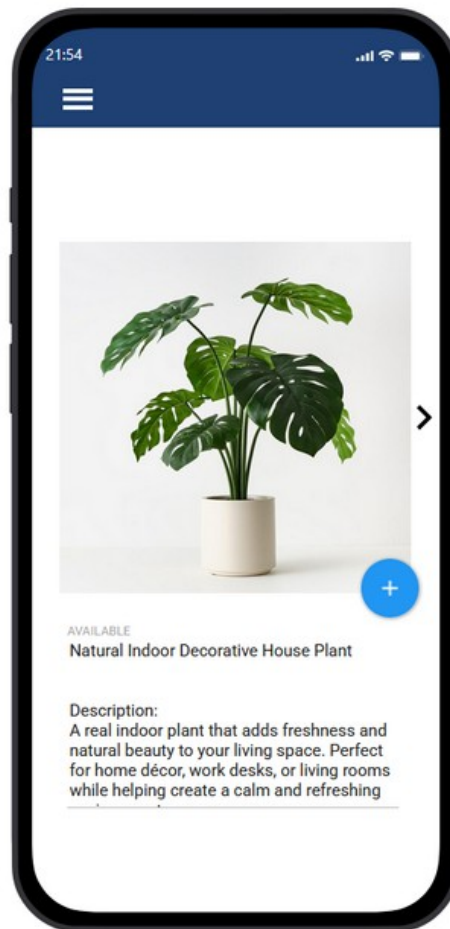


Fig 6: Indoor Plant

Group 3: Cart and Add-to-Cart Confirmation

The cart screen lists added items with thumbnails. After adding something, a big blue checkmark appears with "Added to Cart" text — a simple and clear success message. Users immediately knew their action worked.

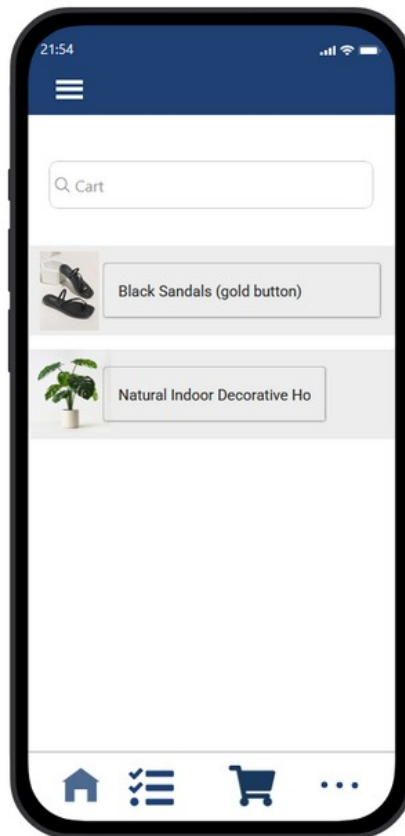


Fig 7: Cart View

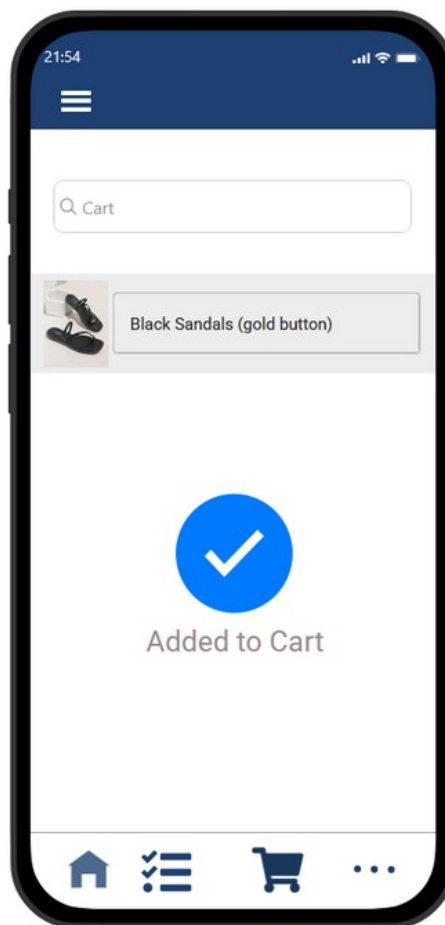


Fig 8: Sandals Added

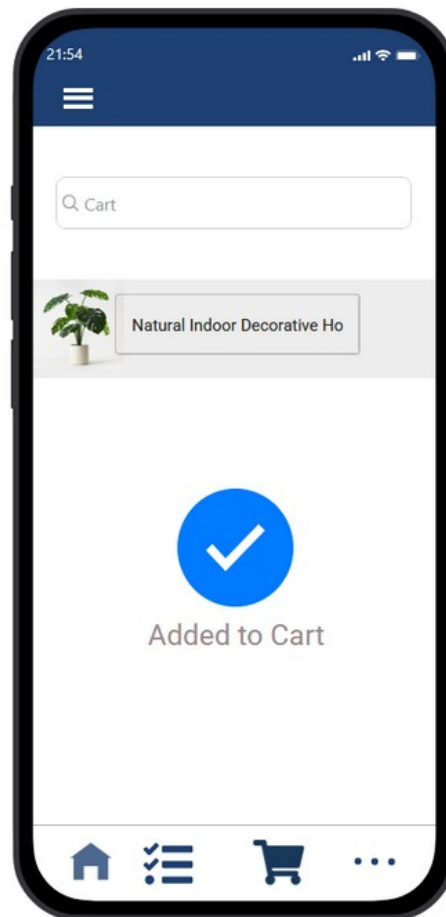


Fig 9: Plant Added

ANALYSIS:

- Users moved through the app quickly with little confusion.
- The bottom tab bar and search bar helped users stay oriented.
- The "+" button for adding to cart was understood by most users.
- The checkmark confirmation made task completion very clear.
- Familiar navigation made the app easy to learn for first-time users.

UNFAMILIAR NAVIGATION:

Unfamiliar Navigation

Unfamiliar navigation uses patterns that people are not used to — like swiping instead of tapping, or arrow buttons that are not clearly labeled. Users have to figure out how things work on their own rather than relying on what they already know.

Group 1: Swipe-Based Home Navigation

The home screen looks the same as before, but instead of tapping a button to go to the next page, users had to swipe. There was only a small "Swipe to Next page >" hint at the bottom. Many users, especially older ones, tapped the text instead of swiping, and could not move forward.

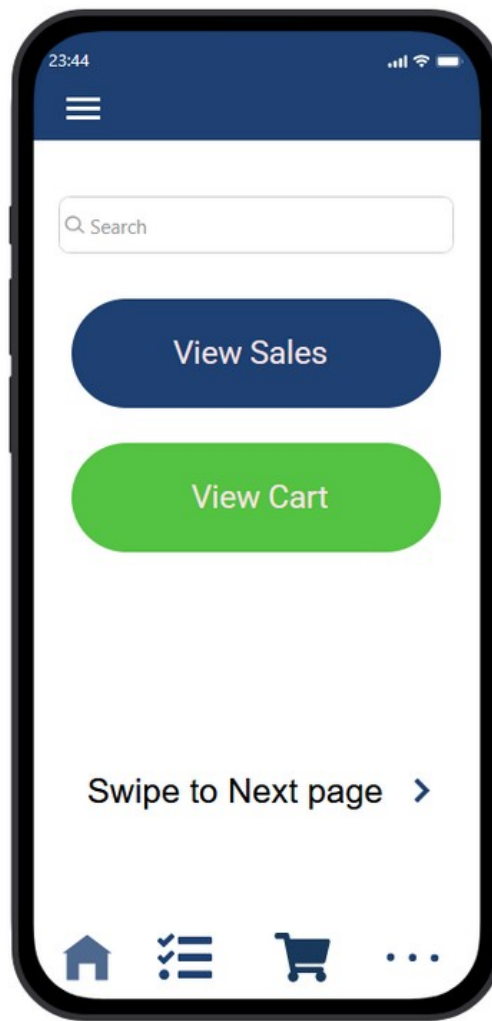


Fig 10: Unfamiliar Home – Swipe to Navigate

Group 2: Arrow-Based Category Navigation

The category screen replaced simple tappable icons with small left and right arrows below each category label. Users were confused about whether to tap the icon or click the arrows. Most users either tapped the icons or ignored the arrows completely.

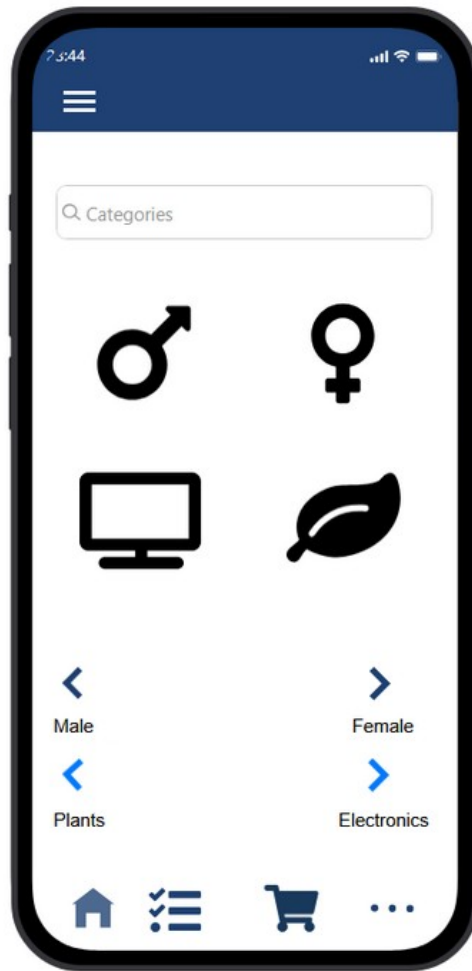


Fig 11: Unfamiliar Categories – Arrow Navigation

ANALYSIS:

- Swipe navigation was hard to find — most users tried tapping instead.
- The arrow buttons under category icons confused users — they did not know which to click.
- Older users gave up more often than younger users.
- Unfamiliar navigation increased the time taken and number of errors.
- Familiar navigation is clearly better for all user groups.

Prototype Links:

Familiar: <https://pr.to/3QAVR7/>

Unfamiliar: <https://pr.to/NQ9XJO/>